PayPal

TALENT ACQUISITION / OPERATING REVIEW

Recharge

Scale the opportunity. Return the talent.

Two parallel U.S. programs | Technology returnship expansion

02

CONCURRENT PROGRAMS

2017-2018 | INTERNAL-STYLE RETROSPECTIVE

Recharge became a scaled talent-delivery program

A proven alternate entry channel was expanded to meet a larger technology recruiting opportunity.

THE SIGNAL

7 of 9

2016 pilot engineers reportedly transitioned into full-time employment - proof of concept, not the expanded cohort conversion rate.

THE DECISION

Double down

Two Recharge programs ran simultaneously, with investment doubled to support expanded recruiting capacity.

THE EXECUTION

60 technologists

A lead technical recruiting effort supported recruiting and onboarding across both programs during the assignment.

EXECUTIVE THESIS **A returnship can become a repeatable workforce channel when recruiting, hiring managers, and program support scale together.**

The talent existed. The pathway did not.

The business opportunity was to widen access to experienced technologists without lowering selection standards.

01

Signal loss

Career breaks can obscure previous experience during traditional resume screening.

02

Manager uncertainty

Hiring teams need evidence of current capability and clarity on expectations.

03

Re-entry friction

A structured paid role can make rebuilding networks and confidence less risky for both parties.

Strategic proposition: identify current capability, provide supported work, and assess longer-term fit.

The evidence behind the expansion

Publicly reported program results and the recruiter-reported 2017-2018 expansion are distinct.

2016

9

PILOT PARTICIPANTS

7 converted to full-time roles after the inaugural U.S. cohort

AUG 2017

30

NEW OPPORTUNITIES

Publicly announced U.S. Recharge expansion; 18 paid weeks

2017-2018

60

TOTAL PROGRAM SCALE

Two concurrent programs with doubled investment (firsthand account)

The 2016 conversion ratio must not be applied to the expanded programs without cohort-level outcome records.

One program became two. Capacity reached 60.

The parallel-program structure expanded the operating responsibility, not merely the number of openings.

PUBLICLY REPORTED 2017 COHORT

30

paid returnship positions



FIRSTHAND EXPANSION

2 × 30

60 total · concurrent program capacity

Investment was doubled; exact budget amounts and per-program spending were not supplied.

Scaling throughput required a shared recruiting engine

A second program creates pressure on manager time, screening consistency, and candidate coordination.

01

Role readiness

Calibrate technical requirements and the returnship-level scope before sourcing.

02

Pipeline development

Create accessible positioning, outreach and a reliable flow of qualified returners.

03

Manager alignment

Keep interview expectations and assessment standards consistent across teams.

04

Program integration

Synchronize offer timing, onboarding, learning, and returnship support.

OPERATIONAL PRINCIPLE | Shared standards do not eliminate flexibility; they make two parallel programs manageable.

Accountability at every handoff

Illustrative operating model; not a reproduced internal PayPal SOP.

OWNER	DESIGN	ATTRACT	ASSESS	SUPPORT	EVALUATE
Sponsor	Set seat / investment goals	Confirm capacity	Unblock execution	Resource the program	Review outcomes
Talent acquisition	Calibrate requisitions	Source & screen	Coordinate interviews	Facilitate offers	Report pipeline
Hiring managers	Define technical work	Engage in outreach	Assess current capability	Coach on real projects	Decide full-time fit
Program / partner	Align structure	Support returner reach	Candidate preparation	Mentor / buddy support	Gather feedback
Participants	Explore suitability	Apply to roles	Interview & validate	Perform paid work	Receive next steps

Historical owners, systems, and approval rights should be validated before reuse as an operating procedure.

From technical demand to a supported returnship

Proposed 2017-2018 process; specific ATS stages and approval paths were not independently verified.

1 **CAPACITY** Program seats and technical needs → 2 **ATTRACT** Reach experienced returners → 3 **SCREEN** Assess skills and reentry readiness → 4 **SELECT** Hiring-manager interviews → 5 **CONFIRM** Paid returnship offer and start → 6 **SUPPORT** Project, mentorship, feedback

REVIEW POINT At the end: manager assessment and a documented full-time / other-next-steps decision.

18 paid weeks made assessment a two-way decision

The reported program length is factual; the stages below are a retrospective operating framework.

01

ENTER

Role context & expectations

02

RAMP

Technical re-entry & team integration

03

CONTRIBUTE

Meaningful delivery & feedback

04

DECIDE

Evaluate fit and next steps

18

PAID WEEKS

No claim is made about exact 2017-2018 week-by-week milestones.

The returnship drew on a broad technical role portfolio

Illustrative recruiting categories from the assignment, not a published roster of every Recharge seat.

ENGINEERING

Java · senior software engineering · full stack

Product and software delivery

PLATFORMS & RISK

Risk platform architecture · business systems analysis

Core platform capabilities

RELEASE & DELIVERY

Mobile release · program management

Delivery coordination and readiness

STAKEHOLDER WORK

Requisition calibration · screening · manager updates

Recruiting operations and communication

This slide describes the recruiter's role mix; it does not imply every family belonged to the same cohort.

The hiring system needs more than a placement count

Distinguish known scale measures from the additional outcome data leadership would need.

CATEGORY	MEASURE	VALUE	EVIDENCE
PROGRAM SCALE	Two concurrent programs	**2**	Firsthand
DELIVERY	Technologists recruited and onboarded	**60**	Firsthand
PROGRAM MODEL	Length of the 2017 U.S. paid returnship	**18 weeks**	Public
TEAM WORKLOAD	Active technical requisitions at a time	**~25-30**	Firsthand
CONVERSION	Full-time conversion for expanded programs	**Not provided**	Not verified
RETENTION	Post-conversion retention / progression	**Not provided**	Not verified

No conversion or retention rate is inferred from the separate 2016 pilot.

Where the recruiter created leverage

The role was more than sourcing: translating program investment into usable technical talent capacity.

CAPACITY

~25-30

Active technical requisitions managed during the assignment

THROUGHPUT

60

Technologists recruited and onboarded across the two programs

CONSISTENCY

2

Concurrent programs supported through common recruiting discipline

Role activity and results are based on firsthand professional experience; program-specific conversion outcomes remain unverified.

Make Recharge a repeatable workforce channel

Retrospective recommendations, not claims that these changes were adopted at PayPal.

01

STANDARDIZE

Reusable role qualification, screening guidance, and candidate communications.

02

EQUIP MANAGERS

Shared returner assessment criteria, project scope, coaching, and midpoint feedback.

03

MEASURE THE WHOLE FUNNEL

Applications, supported starts, conversion decisions, retention, and manager experience.

The objective is lasting access to experienced talent - not a single high-visibility hiring event.

Evidence and reconstruction boundaries

Use this page as the fact-checking reference before presenting the deck outside a private setting.

PUBLIC RECHARGE RECORD

Forbes, 16 Aug 2017: U.S. 30 positions; 18 paid weeks; seven of nine from 2016 pilot converted.

PARTNER PROGRAM GUIDANCE

Path Forward: program staffing, manager preparation, mentorship, and conversion measurement.

HISTORICAL PAYPAL IDENTITY

PayPal 2014 rebrand and later brand reference: overlapping P, indigo, vibrant blue, angled expression.

FIRSTHAND / NOT INDEPENDENTLY PUBLISHED

- Two programs ran concurrently with doubled investment.
- 60 technologists recruited and onboarded; ~25-30 technical requisitions.
- Operational workflow, 18-week stages, and executive recommendations are reconstructions - not original SOPs.

Not included: unpublished approval chains, offer terms, dollar investment, cohort conversion rate, or retention results.